



will also introduce a new peripheral to the Wii family, called the Wii Balance Board. The board is a unique piece of hardware designed to measure a user's body mass index and their centre of gravity. The game will require the user to interact with the Balance Board in various ways—from doing sit-ups on it, to controlling balls by leaning each side while standing on it, to doing push-ups using the board as support. The game will have about 40 different activities falling under one of these categories: Aerobic Exercise, Muscle Conditioning, Yoga Poses, and Balance Games. Wii Fit will also allow players to compare their fitness by using Wii Fit's own channel on the Wii Menu. While no immediate content is planned for release over WiiConnect24, Shigeru Miyamoto has suggested that there could be possibilities to take advantage of the feature in the future, such as using the service to keep in contact with a doctor to help with rehabilitation, or with a fitness specialist to help with training exercises.

The Games giveth, and The Games taketh away—our fat. Amen.

Alan Wake

TBA 2008

Psychological Action Thriller

PC X360

From the creators of Max Payne, comes Alan Wake—a “psychological action thriller.” The game engine is designed to take advantage of multi-core processors, and it has been demonstrated at a press event to offer photo-realistic graphic qualities (a sweet-ass tornado), and dynamic shadows that change according to the position of the sun. Gameplay in *Alan Wake* revolves around the concept of light and dark—the game's enemies are vulnerable to light. As such, the flashlight you conveniently just happened to leave the house with turns invaluable. You will also be required to place booby-traps

and creatively take advantage of any and all light sources within Alan Wake's world. The world itself is vast and allows for free-roaming similar to the *Grand Theft Auto* series. With a free reign over his environment, the game hopes to offer the player open ways to achieve specific goals. Unlike *GTA*, though, *Alan Wake* is more character-driven and story-oriented and follows the tribulations of the protagonist Wake as he suffers from insomnia and tries to make sense of bizarre events which have taken over his waking world. Lead Designer Petri Järvillehto puts forth that the game should not be directly compared to what Max Payne offered, stating, “...intense cinematic action is something that we love to do, and Alan Wake features tense combat gameplay as well, but all things considered the game has a lot more emphasis on adventure and exploration than what Max Payne did.” Driving, for example, would be an integral part of the game as well.

Just for giggles, this should have been developed by Insomniac Games. We are easily amused

Fallout 3

Q4 2008

Action RPG

PC X360 PS3



The torch to the venerable *Fallout* series has passed on from Black Isle Studios to Bethesda Softworks, and regardless of whether you hate or love the idea of Bethesda getting the hands on the IP, we all await *Fallout 3*'s release sometime next year—bouquets and brickbats in hand. Similar to the previous titles, *Fallout 3* will be set in a post-nuclear United States. You will take on a role of a resident of one of the underground nuclear shelters—Vault 101, residing in Washington D.C. Starting the game as a child, you will first be asked to choose you features and looks and as you grow up, you will then be able to distribute points to key attributes defining you (such as Strength, Agility, Luck, Perception, etc.). The game will later see you leaving the vault in search of your father, focusing on non-linear gameplay, a good story, and black comedy. *Fallout 3* will be rated M for Mature, and will have the same sort of adult themes, violence, and depravity that are characteristic of the *Fallout* series. (If you haven't played the previous games, now is a good time to rectify that—these are two of the best games ever made!) Combat will be a mix of real-time and semi-turn-based and will feature slow-motion decapitations, exploding heads, and

Alan
WAKE